

Chapter 87-1

What followed was an even longer silence than before. The System seemed not to know how to answer Liang Shi's question.

After a long time—so long that Liang Shi thought the System would forcibly go offline to avoid the matter—

That eerie mechanical voice sounded again: 【Sorry, Host. Because you are the first person to bring up this matter, Little Tong just urgently went to discuss it with the higher-ups.】

Inexplicably, Liang Shi let out a breath of relief.

Good—there was room for discussion, which meant there was hope.

"What was the result of the discussion?" Liang Shi asked.

System: 【Since the swap between you and the original owner was a subjective accident, we are currently correcting a past mistake. The Bureau has taken into consideration that the original owner grew up to become what she is now due to significant objective environmental interference. Therefore, if the Host is willing, you can compile the interference factors the original owner experienced during her growth. The Bureau will use this as important evidence to apply for a re-examination on behalf of the original owner. This evidence will also serve as an important reference when the Interstellar Court reopens the case for retrial, and they will consider reducing the original owner's punishment accordingly.】

【PS: Please note, Host—if you choose to accept this mission, your mission duration will change to indefinite. That is, until this mission is completed, the System will accompany you as you grow, until the mission is finished.】

【Another PS: This mission is optional. There is no reward and no punishment. Once accepted, it cannot be abandoned—until death.】

【Little Tong's friendly reminder: Even if you obtain enough evidence, it will only serve as grounds for sentence reduction and cannot be a key factor in releasing the original owner. If the original owner wants to leave the Interstellar Prison, she must pass the interstellar labor reform and the danger level test conducted by detection instruments. If the Interstellar Court's assessment of her is "mild," she can be released once her danger level reaches S.】

【Most most most importantly, Host, you don't need to do so much for her! (Many things won't be useful just because you do them.)】

"I choose to accept." With only slight hesitation, Liang Shi chose to take on this mission.

Currently, she and Xu Qingzhu had already sorted out quite a few clues. The most impactful one was arranging for the original owner to live in a "coffin room"¹ for nearly seven years.

A normal person would go crazy if they didn't die first.

As for the matter with Yang Jiani, Liang Shi was more inclined to believe it was something Qiu Zimin had done to herself².

But Liang Shi felt that what Qiu Zimin did to the original owner went far beyond this. She had intended to drive the original owner insane from the start, so there must be more evidence to uncover.

A scene had once appeared in Liang Shi's dreams—it had only appeared that one time.

It was an image of the original owner trapped in a dark room, being whipped.

That incident should also be related to Qiu Zimin, but she didn't know who Qiu Zimin had sent her to that time.

Anyway, the System said to collect interference factors from the growth process to help reduce the original owner's culpability. It didn't say how many needed to be collected.

Liang Shi now had at least one in hand, so she could choose to pause this mission at any time.

Liang Shi accepted this mission with almost no psychological burden.

The System still didn't know Liang Shi's thoughts. The moment Liang Shi chose to accept, the System froze for two seconds and emitted a grating, crackling electrical sound that made Liang Shi's scalp tingle.

"Aren't you going to get this System fixed?" Liang Shi asked. "You're so rich—fixing a System should only take a minute, right?"

System: 【There's nothing wrong with me!】

Liang Shi: "..."

Her head was about to malfunction from that electrical noise.

After being teased by Liang Shi, the System continued the previous topic: 【I already reminded you that some things won't be useful even if you do them. Why don't you ever listen? A Host who doesn't heed the System's words will surely suffer losses before their eyes. The Interstellar Court's sentencing standards are mostly based on the criminal's mental danger level assessment. The two complement each other, so the Host's evidence can only serve as reference. The Bureau will do its best to help, but it may not necessarily be able to.】

Liang Shi: "..."

That's not what you said just now.

But this System often manipulated her before issuing missions, then showed a different face after she accepted.

Liang Shi was already used to it.

Besides, even if it was useless, she still wanted to try.

"Don't you have to do something first to know if it's useful or not?" Liang Shi's gentle tone revealed confidence. "If you think about the meaning of everything before doing it, then there's no point."

System: 【...】

How annoying!

Got lectured again.

Footnotes:

¹ **Coffin room (棺材房):** Refers to the extremely small, cramped room that the original owner was forced to live in during her childhood. The term "coffin room" is used in Chinese to describe tiny living spaces that are barely larger than a coffin, emphasizing how inhumane and psychologically damaging this living arrangement was.

² **Done to herself:** This is slightly ambiguous in the original text. It could mean either (a) something Qiu Zimin arranged to happen to Liang Shi (the original owner) rather than to Yang Jiani's daughter, or (b) the incident with Yang Jiani was orchestrated by Qiu Zimin against the original Liang Shi. Based on context from earlier chapters, this refers to Qiu Zimin sending the young original owner to Yang Jiani's house where she was abused.